

CAUSATIVE VERBS



What are causative verbs?

- A causative verb shows that the subject causes another person or thing to do an action, instead of performing the action themselves.
- In other words: The subject is responsible for the action, but another person (or thing) actually performs it.
- Subject (causes) → Another person (does the action)
- I repaired my car. (I repaired it myself.)
- I had my car repaired. (Someone else repaired it for me.)



Why do we use causative verbs?

- *We use causative verbs to express:*
 - asking someone to do something
 - paying someone to do something
 - forcing someone to do something
 - persuading someone to do something
 - allowing someone to do something
 - getting something done
 - arranging services
 - experiencing something unexpectedly



The Main Causative Verbs

- make
- have
- get
- let
- help
- force
- persuade
- convince
- allow
- require
- order
- cause
- encourage
- permit



TYPE 1 — MAKE

- **Make = force someone to do something.** The person has **no choice**.
- **Structure:** Subject + make + person + base verb (No "to")
- The teacher **made** us **stay** after class.
- My parents **made** me **clean** my room.
- The boss **made** everyone **work** overtime.
- The movie **made** me **cry**.



Passive

- **Structure:** Subject + be made + to infinitive
- Notice: **to** appears in passive.
 - I was **made to apologize**.
 - He was **made to leave**.
 - We were **made to wait**.
- Common mistake
 - ❌ She made me to cry. ✅ She made me cry.



TYPE 2 — HAVE

- Have has two completely different causative meanings.
- **A. Have someone do something**
- Meaning - Arrange or instruct someone to do something.
- Structure: **Subject + have + person + base verb**
 - I'll **have** my assistant **call** you.
 - She **had** the mechanic **check** the brakes.
 - The manager **has** the secretary **print** reports everyday.



TYPE 2 — HAVE

- B. Have something done
- *Meaning - Someone else performs a service for you.*
- Structure: **Subject + have + object + V3/ed**
 - I **had** my hair **cut**.
 - She **had** her house **ainted**.
 - They **had** the roof **repaired**.
 - We **had** the computer **fixed**.
 - He **had** his teeth **cleaned**.
- Notice - You did NOT cut your own hair. Someone else did it.



TYPE 3 — GET

- ***Get is similar to have but slightly less formal. A. Get someone to do something. Meaning - Persuade, convince or manage to make someone do something.***
- **Structure: Subject + get + person + to infinitive**
 - I got my brother to help me.
 - She got him to apologize.
 - We got the children to clean their rooms.
- **Difference: Make = force | Get = persuade**
 - The teacher made him study.
 - The teacher got him to study.
 - The first is stronger.



TYPE 3 — GET

- B. Get something done
- Structure: Subject + get + object + V3/ed
- *Meaning - Arrange for someone else to do something.*
 - I'm **getting** my phone **repaired**.
 - She got her nails done.
 - They got the windows cleaned.
 - He got his passport renewed.
- Difference: **Have my hair cut. | Get my hair cut.**
- Both are correct. "**Get**" is more **common** in everyday English.



TYPE 4 — LET

- *Meaning - Allow or permit.*
- **Structure:** Subject + let + person + V1 (No "to")
 - My parents **let** me **drive**.
 - She **lets** her children **stay up late**.
 - They won't **let** us **enter**.
- **Passive** - "**Let**" is rarely used in passive instead use **allow / permit**
- I was **allowed / permitted** to enter. NOT ~~I was let to enter.~~



TYPE 5 — HELP

- *Help has two correct structures.*
- **Structure 1: help + person + base verb**
 - She **helped** me **carry** the boxes.
- **Structure 2: help + person + to infinitive**
 - She **helped** me **to carry** the boxes.
- Both are correct.



OTHER CAUSATIVE VERBS

- **Force** – Meaning - Strong obligation.
- Structure: **S + force + person + to V1**
 - The police **forced** him **to stop**.
- **Persuade** – Meaning - Convince.
- Structure: **S + persuade + person + to V1**
 - She **persuaded** me **to apply**.
- **Order** – Meaning – Give commands
- Structure: **S + order + person + to V1**
 - The officer **ordered** everyone **to leave**.



OTHER CAUSATIVE VERBS

- **Convince** – Meaning - Change someone's opinion.
- Structure: **S + convince + person + to infinitive**
 - He convinced her to stay.
- **Encourage** – Meaning - Give confidence.
- Structure: **S + encourage + person + to infinitive**
 - My teacher encouraged me to continue.
- **Allow** – Meaning - Permit
- Structure: **S + allow + person + to infinitive**
 - They allowed us to enter.



OTHER CAUSATIVE VERBS

- **Permit** – Meaning - Permit
- Structure: **S - permit + person + to V1**
 - Smoking isn't permitted.
- **Require** – Meaning - Say something is **necessary or compulsory**.
- Structure: **S + require + object + to infinitive**
 - The law requires drivers to wear seat belts.
- **Cause** – Meaning - Make something happen
- Structure: **S + cause + object + to infinitive**
 - The storm caused the bridge to collapse.



Structures

Have

More formal

I had my car repaired.

Common in writing

Get

More conversational

I got my car repaired.

Common in speaking

Verb

Meaning

Structure

Make

Force

make + person + base verb

Get

Persuade

get + person + to infinitive

Have

Arrange

have + person + base verb

Let

Allow

let + person + base verb



Active and Passive Causatives

- **Active** - *The subject causes another person to act.*

- I had the plumber fix the sink.
- She made him apologize.
- We got them to help.

- **Passive** - *The subject receives a service.*

- I had my sink fixed.
- She got her dress cleaned.
- He had his car washed.



Tense Changes

- **Present-** I have my hair cut every month.
- **Past** - I had my hair cut yesterday.
- **Future** - I'll have my car repaired tomorrow.
- **Present Perfect** - I've had my phone repaired.
- **Past Perfect** - She had had the roof repaired before winter.
- **Future Perfect** - They will have had the house painted by Friday.



Modal Verbs

- **Can** - I **can** have it repaired.
- **Must** - You **must** get your passport renewed.
- **Should** - You **should** have your eyes tested.
- **Might** - We **might** get the kitchen remodeled.
- **Would** - If I were you, I **would** get my hair cut.
- **Will** - We **will** get our fences painted next week.



Negative / Question forms

- I didn't **have** my car **repaired**.
- She hasn't **had** her hair **cut**.
- Don't **let** him **leave**.
- The teacher didn't **make** us **stay**.
- Did you **have** your house **ainted**?
- Have you **had** your teeth **cleaned**?
- Who **made** you **cry**?
- Can you **get** him **to help**?



Common Mistakes

- **✗ Make + to infinitive**
 - Wrong - She made me to leave. | Correct - She made me leave.
- **✗ Let + to infinitive**
 - Wrong - They let me to drive. | Correct - They let me drive.
- **✗ Have + person + to infinitive**
 - Wrong - I had him to fix it. | Correct - I had him fix it.
- **✗ Get + person + base verb**
 - Wrong - I got him help me. | Correct - I got him to help me.
- **✗ Passive after make**
 - Wrong - I was made leave. | Correct - I was made to leave.



Verb	Meaning	Structure	Example
Make	Force	make + person + V1	The teacher made us study.
Have	Arrange	have + person + V1	I had my assistant call you.
Have	Service	have + object + V3/ed	I had my hair cut.
Get	Persuade	get + person + to V1	She got him to help.
Get	Service	get + object + V3	I got my phone repaired.
Let	Allow	let + person + V1	They let us leave early.
Help	Assist	help + person + (to) V1	She helped me (to) finish.

Verb	Meaning	Structure	Example
force	Compel	force + person + to V1	They forced him to resign.
persuade	Convince	persuade + person + to V1	I persuaded her to join.
allow	Permit	allow + person + to V1	They allowed us to stay.
encourage	Motivate	encourage + person + to V1	Ali encouraged me to study.
cause	Make happen	cause + object + to V1	The accident caused traffic to stop.
order	Command	order + person + to V1	The judge ordered him to pay the fine.
force	Compel	force + person + to V1	They forced him to resign.

Quick Rule to Remember

- **make + person + V1** → force
- **have + person + V1** → arrange
- **have + object + V3/ed** → someone does a service
- **get + person + to V1** → persuade
- **get + object + V3/ed** → someone does a service
- **let + person + V1** → allow
- **help + person + (to) V1** → assist

